BRIGHAM YOUNG UNIVERSITY IDAHO

ED 200: Teaching as a Profession

- **Class times: T/Th 9:00-10:00 (Section 2) HIN 307.**
- **Office Hours: M/T/Th 12:30-3 HIN 249.***

Part I: Course Introduction

Instructor: Benjamin Pacini **(**But, like, call me BroPa). pacinib@byui.edu**. 801.618.7865.**** Zoom: 899.634.5818.

Course Introduction and Invitation: What is school for?

This class is a bullet train running through philosophy, psychology, history, innovation, and great teaching. We're going to talk about what the great reformers wanted to build, and spend some time on whether they actually succeeded. This is the class where you'll start to ask hard questions–of yourself, of history, and of the education system as it stands.

In particular, we will cover the following essential questions:

- What is great teaching?
- Why is it important to think well?
- What can education be?
- How does education align with the gospel?
- What does it mean to be an educator? What do I need to prepare?

This is the first class required of all education majors. As such, we will use our time to build you into future professional educators–covering interviewing, resume-building, letters of recommendation, and what you will need in order to successfully graduate. You will leave this class knowing how to excel in these categories.

More importantly, you will learn how to think, how to write, and how to enter contemporary conversations about education in thoughtful, researched, nuanced, and constructive ways. This also means that we are going to ask tough questions, learn how to listen, and build on each other's understanding. The goal is *not* simply to have you learn a list of philosophies--your job is to *learn how to learn.*

More importantly, we will study what great education is–and isn't. We'll use frameworks (including Danielson and Teaching in the Savior's Way) to begin to interrogate excellence in education–and to begin to set you on a path toward being excellent in education.

I don't apologize for being an overly-excited, happily intense, moderately insane personal trainer. Feel the burn--and love it! We work hard, but it'll change the way you see everything in life.

Welcome to Ed 200. Buckle up. We're going to have fun. So excited to have you!

Brother Benjamin Pacini (BroPa)

Required texts:

"The Framework for Teaching"; Danielson Group (2013)
https://danielsongroup.org/downloads/2013-framework-teaching-evaluation-instrument

"Framework for Teaching Smartcard"; Danielson Group (2013)
https://danielsongroup.org/downloads/2013-framework-teaching-evaluation-instrument

"Teaching in the Savior's Way"; The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints (2015)
https://www.churchofjesuschrist.org/bc/content/ldsorg/manual/13301_000_TchngSvrsWay_Web.pdf?lang=eng

*Seriously, just come by. I'm off campus Wed/Fri, but other times I'm easy to find. I'll bring the memes, candy, and high-brow humor.
**I'm a terrible texter. I'm mediocre at answering phones, but I'm decent w/email. Best of all is the zoom channel, which I'll show in class.
***This is your first penguin. PENGUIN! (Still only counts as one.)
**** Google voice is great because it has a great spam screen to keep out detestable vacuum salespeople. Say who you are, and it'll put you through.

Part II: Mission, Outcomes, Standards, and Alignment

The BYU-Idaho Teacher Education Department Vision:

Follow the example of the Savior to become outstanding educators who empower learners to reach their divine potential

BYU Idaho Mission Statement and Institutional Learning Objectives:

BYU-Idaho's mission is to develop disciples of Jesus Christ who are leaders in their homes, the Church, and their communities.

BYU Idaho Institutional Learning Objectives:

1. **Disciples of Jesus Christ:** Disciples of Jesus Christ have a testimony of Jesus Christ as the Son of God and strive to follow Him.
    1) Understand Doctrine and Principles of the Restored Gospel
    2) Make and Keep Covenants
    3) Live Standards of Honor and Integrity
    4) Work as Faithful Stewards of The Lord

2. **Sound thinkers:** Sound thinkers frame and solve problems using creative and critical thinking.
    1) Problem Solving
    2) Critical Thinking
    3) Inquiry and Analysis
    4) Innovation/Creativity

3. **Effective Communicators:** Effective communicators develop and express ideas that are purposeful, organized, and clear.
    1) Structure Content to Accomplish Specific Purposes
    2) Follow Appropriate Processes of Content Development
    3) Address Targeted Audiences Using Appropriate Modes of Delivery
    4) Express Ideas Clearly

4. **Skilled Collaborators:** Skilled collaborators work effectively with others to accomplish a shared vision.
    1) Fulfill Individual Responsibilities
    2) Facilitate Contributions of Others
    3) Foster Productive Group Climates
    4) Respond to Conflicts in Constructive Ways

How does this relate to our class?
This class is built on creating sound thinkers: the logical fallacies quiz and weekly essays will force you to think carefully and express yourself cogently (ILO 2.2 and ILO 3.4). You will be tasked with improving the quality of the course (ILO 2.1) and communicating it to me professionally (ILO 3.3) By sorting through the associated research, you will be asked to push yourself to understand what the research says about various teaching techniques, and to become an informed user of research (ILO 2.3). You will be expected to create quizzes, not merely pass them, and will assess your teammates and teach them directly (ILO 2.4). That teaching will be excellent preparation for you as you become great teachers (ILO 3.1). This course is designed for you to focus on refining your abilities, and improving your content rather than a normal grading scheme (ILO 3.2) You will work in groups to teach each other the most important content of the course (ILO 4.1 & 4.2) and will be assessed on your ability to build the culture of this class and your group (ILO 4.3 & 4.4). Most important of all, we will do everything we do through the gospel lens, including thinking about the deepest purposes of real education (ILO 1.1) and how gospel teaching is a part of our work as covenant-keeping saints (ILO 1.2). We will consistently ask how we can improve in our role as stewards of God's children–and of the resources with which we may be entrusted (ILO 1.4)--and we will emphasize and focus on the nature of education as a fundamentally moral, spiritual endeavor (ILO 1.3).

Course Outcomes:

1. The teacher candidate will gain a historical perspective of the purposes and functions of education, the developmental processes and theories of thinking and learning, and the intentions of efforts to reform education.
    a. Idaho Core Standards [1a, 1c, 2a, 7c, 10a, 10d]
2. The teacher candidate will develop a cultural perspective of education through the exploration of the roles and responsibilities of an educator, the look and feel of today's classrooms, and the important issues and challenges encountered by educators in a diverse society.
    a. Idaho Core Standards [2m, 3n, 3r, 5c, 9d, 9e, 9f, 10d, 10f]
3. The teacher candidate will examine philosophical systems in education and their role in defining the skills of a good educator.
    a. Idaho Core Standards [7a]
4. The teacher candidate will explore the methods and practices of effective teachers.
    a. Idaho Core Standards [1b, 1c, 3c, 5d, 6a, 7o, 8e, 8r]
    b. Technology Standards [3a, 3c, 4a]
5. The teacher candidate will identify necessary characteristics of an educator in order to develop an individual philosophy of education and the impact this philosophy will have on the learning environment.
    a. Idaho Core Standards [2l, 3b, 4q, 5r, 9c, 9h, 9i, 9l, 10s]
    b. Technology Standards [3a, 3c]

Knowledge Statements:

- Identify historical changes in the world of education, past and present, projecting their impact on future trends.
- Identify learning theories and describe the developmental processes of each.
- Identify historical issues influencing educational reform initiatives and their impact upon public education.
- Recognize that inclusive public school classrooms typically include students from diverse backgrounds with individualized needs: developmental, intellectual, exceptional, linguistic, cultural, and socio-economic.
- Identify elements that contribute to a classroom culture and an environment conducive to learning.
- Aware of existing policy, issues, and events impacting today's schools.
- Examine the defining characteristics of traditional educational philosophies.
- Identify the principles and actions of the educational philosophies that align with the doctrines and teachings of Jesus Christ, the Master Teacher.
- Identify the essential, research-based characteristics of and methods used by effective teachers.
- Identify the professional expectations of educators in public school settings.
- Identify personal bias that may impact student relationships and teaching performance.

Understanding

- Recognize the different ways that children learn.
- History impacts education; education impacts history.
- Efforts to differentiate instruction can positively impact all learners.
- Demonstrate an awareness of personal biases relating to cultural issues.
- Recognize specific actions and dispositions modeled by effective teachers.
- Demonstrate a willingness to learn new technologies and implement newly acquired skills and tools into own learning.

Performance

- Articulate an individual philosophy describing personal beliefs and dispositions that will influence the teacher candidate's performance based upon learning theory, educational philosophy and gospel principles.
- Teacher candidates conduct themselves professionally by demonstrating the dispositions of the profession recognized through their own daily behaviors, attitudes, and actions.
- Teacher candidates demonstrate the willingness and ability to collaborate effectively with others.
- Comprehensive review, completion and submission of approved BYU-Idaho Graduation Plan.

Part III: Course Breakdown and Grading:

Grading:
Please reference the University's grading explanation here. Letter Grades are assigned according to the following scale:

A	93-100	A-	90-93	B+	87-89	B	83-86
B-	80-82	C+	77-79	C	73-76	C-	70-73
D+	67-69	D	63-66	D-	60-62	F	0-59

Grade Breakdown:

20% Contribution to Community: (Preparation, Participation, Pizzaz, and Attendance)
25% Teaches
25% Weekly Essays
30% Weekly Projects

- **Weekly Essays:** You will be expected to submit one essay each week on the topic of contemporary issues in education. They are very straightforward. They are pass/fail: you either get 100% or 0%. You should copy the format of the weekly essays exemplar but put in your own words and experience.
- **Contribution to Community**: When I say "contribution to community," I include preparation, attendance, and participation, but also something more: submitting memes to the thread, capturing great quotes, or providing a bit of daily inspiration. You will be asked to do fun, silly, joyful things just for the sake of making connections (that's the pizzaz I'm talking about). Do more than just show up: help us create an awesome class culture.
    - ***Attendance***: attendance is required–but not sufficient for success–in this class. You can miss two classes for any reason. After that, there will be significant grade penalties. If you don't end up needing to use the freebies, they will help your grade. Make a schedule for yourself to complete attendance checks: they're easy, but you need to remember to do them. Also, make sure to take good notes, and then upload them to attendance checks to earn credit. In addition, I want you to build the habits of character to be intentionally positive, solutions-oriented, creative, genuine, proactive, friendly, etc--precisely because there is so much negativity in the world. It matters more than you know. Do not plaster on a fake smile--be authentic. Ask questions, participate, and build others up. You should come looking fancy on days when you are teaching. Remember "dress down" days? Make it a "dress up" day.
    - ***Oral exams:*** Oral exams are awesome. They're mildly terrifying, but you will learn so much. Come prepared, and know enough to be able to speak to anything in the reading. Students consistently report that oral exams are somewhat stressful–and also, incredibly rewarding. You can use one "mulligan" when you are not ready for the oral exam, but you must ask to use it before the oral exam begins, and must be proactive in talking to me about the issue.
    - ***Readings:*** Reading checks are just to give you a chance to be honest about your reading. Make sure to set an alarm to get them done. Readings will be chosen by your peers (and you!) for one of your weekly teaches. You are expected to take notes on them and post them in your weekly essays, and to have read them before class begins. If you haven't, you should talk to Brother Pacini about it. If you are spending more than 45 minutes on a reading, talk to BroPa. You're supposed to learn, not lose your mind.
- **Teaches:** Within your group, each person will be assigned to teach various times during the semester. They will be responsible for explaining the assignment using the best possible quality teaching techniques and methods. Tuesday teaches will focus on a contemporary issue in education. Thursday teaches will focus on how to complete the Saturday assignment.
- **Weekly Projects:** In order to help you complete the major common assessments, there will be one major assignment due each Saturday. These assignments are medium in length (2-3 hours) in order to help you complete as you go along.

Common Assessments:
There are various common assessments in this class, but they are all a part of the personal educational website. Students will complete them piecemeal in weekly assignments. The common assessments are:

- Educational Website
- Statement of Personal Education Philosophy (Included as part of the website)
- Statement of Effective Teaching (Included as part of the website)
- Grad plan and timeline (Included as part of the website)

Groups: We will sort you into groups in the first week or two of class. Your group membership is one of the most important predictors of your success in this class. You should get each other's numbers, text early and often, connect, and consider each other running buddies. (A running buddy is both a friend and an accountability partner.) If your group is running at peak-efficiency, you will make good friends and have a deeply joyful experience. Please let me know ASAP if your group is struggling with communication or work completion.

Questions and Communication
In the first week of class, you will learn about our zoom channel: please check it daily. (You can check on any non-chromebook computer, or any smartphone.) While I'm always happy to answer questions, please do all you can to ask peers and consult class materials (e.g. syllabus) before reaching out. Questions that may apply to the whole class can be asked in the Zoom chat; personal questions should be emailed. I encourage people to ask their group first, the zoom channel second, the TA third, and BroPa fourth--to build your capacity to answer your own questions. That said, just ask! I love interacting with students, and will happily answer even if you go out of order.

Extra Credit: Make-up work opportunities and extra credit are approved at my discretion; focus on submitting high quality projects first. Impressive projects, high quality work, or powerful insights can also earn some extra credit points. Sometimes good memes. Rarely. But sometimes. If you have concerns about your grades ***see me as early as possible.*** You can miss two days of attendance with no penalty–any further absence will incur steep penalties, however. I often attempt to record class–you may not view those recordings without my approval, and should ask me or the TAs for permission, or you will not get credit on the attendance check. You should not rely on those recordings, however, as recordings sometimes fail. You should get the information you need from class. In the event of technical failure, students are still responsible for the learning that takes place in sessions.

Peer Grading: You will do a lot of peer grading and peer feedback. You are about to be teachers, so this is good training. I expect you to grade with **kindness, honesty, and care**. While you will give suggested grades, I am ultimately responsible for grades in this course.

Grade Appeals: If you would like to appeal a grade, please email me. Note that I will regrade any assignment once--but I regrade the full assignment, not just the piece that a student may feel was unfair.

Final Deadline: Near the end of the semester, I will announce a "drop-dead" deadline by which all assignments (even late assignments) must be submitted. Be certain that any work you would like to have considered is turned in before that date and time.

Syllabus changes: The syllabus and course schedule may be changed at any time. I will inform you of any changes as quickly as is reasonable.

Part IV: Course Expectations and Explanations:

Required Course Materials:

- You will need a functioning laptop. It is your job to make sure it works. (Not joking.)
- Bring a nameplate (Or make one using white card stock and black marker. Write large and clear.)
- You will need a dry erase marker, a sheet protector, and something to use to erase with (old sock is fine).
- You will need access to your BYUI email and the course zoom channel.

Course Policies and Procedures:

Statement on dress code, masks, and honor code:
I love the honor code. I wish people who complained about it realized how lucky we are to have it. I only wish that the world had one, too. If you have concerns about me, I'd love to discuss. Please understand that I feel it is important to live up to what we've agreed to–because we agreed to those things.

Please understand that I will enforce the honor code and the dress and grooming standards. Typically, my students are great–no issues. Understand, however: I used to be a middle school assistant principal. I am evil. I like correcting people. Do yourself (and me) a favor, and always come in full dress code. Always be honest. Be wise. Be kind to yourself, and keep the rules without being asked. Be kind to me by not making me say something awkward. Wear masks. Put them over your nose. Keep the honor code. If you have an issue with anything, bring it up *before* you break it. (I don't care about the holes in the jeans, but you will feel weird about them. Trust me.) Also, I am pretty evil. Seriously. Lol.

Dress Code:

- For regular classes attendance: BYUI-approved dress and grooming standards. Masks required. No holes.
    - I love all of you dearly. Please don't make me have to talk with you about silly things.
    - Holes in jeans are a silly thing. (It's about professionalism.)
    - Do head-shoulders-knees-and-toes with a roommate if you're not sure. We will discuss in class.
- For Presentations: Show effort in your appearance to present and demonstrate professionalism. Masks required.

Integrity note: Please note that not being prepared for class is a minor grading issue. Pretending to be prepared when one is not is an integrity issue. Whether for teaches, oral exams, or attendance, I don't expect students to perfectly submit everything–and in fact, am very easy to work with when life gets crazy. (For example, students will have the chance to opt out of one reading per semester with no consequence, called "a mulligan" so long as they communicate this before the class begins.) Please understand, however, that I take integrity issues very seriously. Do not pretend to have completed an assignment when you haven't.

Late Work
You can always submit work early--and are encouraged to. Major projects that are submitted on time or early may be ***submitted and resubmitted as many times as necessary to get to the grade you desire.***[1] You will also get feedback on each submission to help you improve the quality of your work: the goal is to learn from the process of submission, feedback, improvement, and resubmission. Late submissions on ***major projects only*** will not be penalized except that you only get one shot to submit. Late reading checks and attendance checks will be penalized, but only a little–and you can still turn them in for partial credit no matter how late they are. You will get somewhat less feedback if you submit late, and you will be graded by me. I will not intentionally grade you harshly, but I do tend to grade more harshly than peers and TAs.

Some assignments cannot be submitted late by their nature (like group presentations). Submitting them late without prior approval will result in an automatic zero grade. Minor assignments are generally not accepted late.

Please be mature and professional about extenuating circumstances. (*cough* family-vacations-aren't-emergencies *cough*) You will find me to be very understanding, if you are very responsible. It's your job to reach out to me early!

Zeroes

Because of my unusual grading system, you will get more zeroes than you are used to. Don't stress. Talk to me. If you have a zero, the chances are good that you missed something important and I need you to try again. Also, note that I ask the TAs to always put in zeroes once an assignment is done. I find that it is kinder to students in the long run when they know that their grade is not where they would like it to be.

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[1] Mastery Based Learning (most effectively promulgated by the brilliant--and brilliantly named--Benjamin Bloom) is a different education paradigm where we flip time and mastery. Rather than hold time constant, and let mastery fluctuate, MBL says that you can take all the time you need on a project, but you must get an excellent score on it. This means that students can work ahead, and go slower if needed. It's really good stuff, and I highly recommend you check it out. See here for more details. (The video is meh, but the documents are pretty good.)

Submitting Links:
Check your links. If they are not working, you will receive **a permanent penalty**, but will be allowed to resubmit. Until we get a working link, you will have a zero.

Note on Emotional Health
I believe strongly that creating emotionally strong, resilient students is about both decreasing stress, and increasing capacity. If discussions of emotional health are sensitive or difficult for you, please let me know as early as possible. I do not claim to have all the right ideas on this, but feel it to be important enough to bring up and discuss.

Additionally, I suspect that many of you lean toward perfectionism: teaching will help with that. You will learn, quickly, the art of "good enough." You should never feel the need to spend 3 hours on a 1 hour assignment. Be wise. Learn how to manage your own time carefully. Learn that excellence is better than perfectionism (including in grades) and know the difference between integrity and scrupulosity.

A thought on emotional health and grades: I hope all of you are aiming for an A. But I hope you realize that the real goal isn't the A, it's the learning--it's the success that you'll have in your classroom someday because of what you learned, the students' lives who will be changed, and the relationships you'll build with teachers, parents, students, and communities--and most importantly, the Lord. This is a very long-term game. You will see your success measured not in months, or even years, but decades and generations.

Sensitive Topics
The world is in tremendous turmoil. The devil is stirring men's hearts up unto anger, and it's hard to even have conversations on some topics. Elder Paul V. Johnson has asked faculty to have both "moral courage" and "intellectual courage." I do not believe that it is in your best interest for me to avoid difficult conversations. To the contrary, learning how to wrestle with difficult topics is one of the most important things you can take from your BYU-Idaho education. As such, I will attempt to do so with openness, sensitivity, and honesty. If there are questions that are important to you, don't hesitate to ask me privately--and if appropriate, I may raise such issues in class, as well. I should also be clear that everything these days is politicized, and everyone is angry. The solution is not to disagree less, but to disagree better. I do not expect you to agree with everything I say--I only expect respect and civility. In that context, I'm happy to discuss things that are pressing to you.

I also want to note just how deeply I believe in the gospel. I want anyone to feel welcome in my classroom, even if they aren't sure about some part or another. Having said that, I hope it is clear how unapologetically I am on the side of the Lord and His church.

On social media and my writings:
A student once complained that I require students to follow me on social media. (I don't. Lol.) You are welcome to, but you are never going to be required to. You should understand that I have opinions on things, including politics, and that we may not agree. If you are willing to be my friend, I'll be happy to add you–but I will not give any brownie points or extra credit for it.

I also have a podcast and write occasionally in various places. If you would like to listen to my podcast, please click here. (Also, and I say this with love, get a hobby.)

Two of the pieces I have published may be relevant to my classes, however, so I have included them below.

You Are Safe In My Classroom: A Personal Statement on Truth, Belonging, and Pride Flags. This article is an explanation of how important it is to create a safe place of belonging in my classroom, and also why I don't use pride imagery. It isn't perfect, but it may give you insight into how I feel about things.

An Open Letter to Charity: What I Believe About Education In response to a student's question, I wrote this doctoral paper to answer the question "what do I believe about education?" This is long. I need to edit it (and hope to at some point). It does, however, give the best answer I've been able to come up with about what I believe we should do about education. (I've even left in my professor's comments so you realize how long it is! :D)

Course Calendar
The Course Calendar outlines all assignments, topics, and modules of the class. The instructor reserves the right to make changes in the schedule and syllabus. Students will be informed of changes in a timely manner. This calendar may be found in canvas (iLearn) under the syllabus tab.

Syllabus Changes
This syllabus is a guide and every attempt is made to provide an accurate overview of the course. However, circumstances and events may make it necessary for the instructor to modify the syllabus during the semester and may depend, in part, on the progress, needs, and experiences of the students. Changes to the syllabus will be made with advance notice.

Part V: Standard Disclosures

Academic Honesty
"When you are honest in every way, you are able to enjoy peace of mind and maintain self-respect. You build strength of character, which allows you to be of service to God and others. You are trustworthy in the eyes of God and those around you. If you are dishonest in your words or actions, you hurt yourself and often hurt others as well. If you lie, steal, cheat, or neglect to give the full amount of work for your pay, you lose your self-respect. You lose the guidance of the Holy Ghost" ("Honesty," True to the Faith (2004), 84)

Academic Honesty means students do their own work. This also means their instructors will evaluate that work. Students should not be dishonest—this includes all types of work in their courses. The complete Academic Honesty Policy can be found at http://www.byui.edu/student-honor-office/ces-honor-code/academic-honesty.

All students attending BYU-Idaho have agreed in writing to adhere to the Honor Code. Cheating, which includes plagiarism, will not be tolerated. This includes using materials you did not create and claiming them as your own. Using ideas and resources shared in the teaching community is supported, however you must give attribution and add your own ideas, experience, etc. to found resources. Please check with the instructor before using resources such as Teachers Pay Teachers and Influencer produced materials. Anyone caught cheating will receive a zero on the assignment or exam, will be reported to the Student Honor Office, and may be expelled from the course.

Academic Support
Go to https://www.byui.edu/academic-success-and-tutoring, or come to the McKay Library 272 for information about how the writing, reading, math, and study skills centers can help you increase your success in all of your classes. To schedule a tutor for a specific class, log on to the Academic Support website, click on Tutor Request under Student Services and follow the instructions. Penguin. I'm evil, lol. Who puts a penguin in the standard disclosures? That's like supervillain level evil.

Academic Grievances
Students are encouraged to contact their instructors regarding course-related concerns. If concerns cannot be resolved in this way, students may contact the BYU-Idaho Support Center to formally register a concern or grievance. The Student Grievance Policy can be found here.

Disability Services
BYU-Idaho does not discriminate against persons with disabilities in providing its educational and administrative services and programs and follows applicable federal and state law. This policy extends to the University's electronic and information technologies (EIT).

Students with qualifying disabilities should contact the Disability Services Office at disabilityservices@byui.edu or 208.496.9210. Additional information about Disability Services resources can be found at http://www.byui.edu/disabilities

I am very easy to work with on this. Please know, however, that the best thing I can do for any student is give them resources, empower them, and hold them to a high bar. Talk with me early if I can help in any way. PENGUIN.

Preventing Sexual Misconduct
BYU-Idaho prohibits sex discrimination by its employees and students in all of its education programs or activities. This includes all forms of sexual harassment, such as sexual assault, dating violence, domestic violence, stalking, conditioning a grade or job on participation in sexual conduct, and other forms of unwelcome sexual conduct.

As an instructor, one of my responsibilities is to help create a safe learning environment for my students and for the campus as a whole. University policy requires deans and department chairs, and encourages all faculty, to report every incident of sexual harassment that comes to their attention. If you encounter or experience sexual harassment, please contact the Title IX Coordinator at titleix@byui.edu or 208-496-9209. Additional information about sex discrimination, sexual harassment, and available resources can be found at www.byui.edu/titleix.